PROPOSAL · ALLIED WELDING SYSTEMS

Putting the Operations Bridge to Work

Connecting the order and invoice-checking system to your Sage books and your Monday board, loading your real parts and customers, and training your team to run it.

The ask, in one page

What	Install and connect a system that is already built and tested
Cost	$6,000 fixed, paid across three milestones
Time	7 to 9 working days
Returns	About 2 hours of hand-work per order becomes about 5 minutes
Pays back in	10 weeks at ten orders a week. 5 weeks at twenty.
Ongoing	$350 a month if you want support. Optional.
Risk	You sign off each stage before the next begins
Decision needed	Yes or no, plus a machine and a few hours of your team's time

Today every order is handled four or five times by hand, and supplier invoices are paid with little more than a glance at the order that authorised them. The system removes the handling and, more importantly, does the checking that is not happening at all.

> **Why that matters:** You are a brokerage, so your margin is the gap between what you buy at and what you sell at. Money lost to an unchecked supplier bill does not come off that invoice — it comes off the only thing the business actually sells. That is why the checking matters more than the time saved, and why it is listed first in everything that follows.

The system already exists

The software is written and tested: 150 automatic checks, 60 full order run-throughs and 27 deliberate attempts to push a bad invoice or an uncertifiable heat through it. All pass. **You are not paying for software to be built.** You are paying for it to be connected to your Sage, your board and your parts list, and for your team to be shown how to run it.

Why this pays for itself, and how fast

One assumption, stated plainly: an order absorbs about **two hours** of someone's day today, across reading it, keying it into Sage, working out the supplier split, raising the purchase orders, assembling the packing slip and certificates, and updating the board. If that figure is wrong for Allied, correct it — every number here moves with it, and the table below shows all four of its rows so you can find your own.

What the system actually takes

A complete order — read, matched to your catalogue, split between suppliers, run through every check, sales order and purchase orders written, packing slip produced — was measured at **25 thousandths of a second**. A full line-by-line check of a supplier bill, dispute letter included, at **8 thousandths**. What remains for a person is reading it and saying yes: **about five minutes**.

Orders a week	Hours back a year	Worth at $30/hr	Pays back the $6,000 in
5	498 h	$14,950	21 weeks
10	997 h	$29,900	10 weeks
20	1,993 h	$59,800	5 weeks
40	3,987 h	$119,600	3 weeks

Why that matters: The payback period is the number to judge this on, not the yearly figure. At ten orders a week the system has repaid its cost before the quarter you bought it in has closed. If it then disappointed you completely, the loss is one quarter of one person's admin time — which is about what a decision like this costs in meetings if it is left open too long.

And the busy work can go further than this proposal takes it

Being straight about what is left: once connected, roughly **14 minutes** of hand-work per order remains — forwarding the order email, clicking import in Sage, emailing the purchase orders, and the five-minute review. Reading and checking supplier bills was the largest remaining item and has since been built, which is why that figure is lower than it was.

Stage	Hand-work left	Busy work removed
Today, by hand	120 min	0%
Once it is plugged in (this proposal)	14 min	88%
Plus collecting mail and sending it	7 min	94%
Plus writing straight into Sage	5 min	96%

The two further pieces are **about a week of work in total**, quoted separately and deliberately not bundled here.

> **Why that matters:** They are not in this proposal because none of them is worth buying before the system is writing to your books. Automating the delivery of orders into a system that is not yet connected to Sage buys you a faster route to a queue. Connect it, run it a month, then spend the fortnight — by then the review list will tell you which of the three to do first, instead of anyone guessing.

What you get, and how you know you got it

Three stages. Each has a test you can see with your own eyes, and you sign it off before the next one starts.

> **Why that matters:** Staging it this way is not paperwork. It means that if the work stalls at any point you have something finished and useful, rather than a half-built thing and an invoice.

Stage 1 — Get it running on your machine · $2,400

You get	You will see
The system installed and starting by itself	It survives a restart and opens from an office PC
Your real parts, customers and suppliers loaded	Twenty real part numbers of your choosing resolve correctly
Logins for your named staff, with the right access each	Each person signs in and sees only what they should
Nightly backups that are checked, not just taken	A backup is restored in front of you and opened

> **Why that matters:** Backups are in stage one rather than last because everything the system knows lives in one file. Until that file is copied somewhere, every other deliverable is sitting on a single point of failure.

Stage 2 — Orders flow into Sage · $1,600

Sage has no built-in way for outside software to write into it unless you run the desktop version on the same machine. So this stage delivers the route that works either way: the system produces the Sage files and a person imports them.

You get	You will see
One-click production of the Sage import files	A day of orders imports into Sage with the right customers, lines and accounts
Order numbers that carry on from your existing Sage numbering	Three orders in a row get the next three numbers you expect
A report of what was sent and what came back	Every order in a test batch is accounted for
A written answer on which Sage you run and what that allows	Delivered to you in writing

Optional extra — remove the last click · $1,800

If you run the desktop Sage, the system can write straight into your company file and the import step disappears. **This is not assumed and not included.** A one-minute check on your machine settles whether it is even possible, before any money is committed.

Why that matters: Pricing the optimistic route and discovering halfway through that it was never available is the single most common way integration projects overrun. Quoting the route that always works, and treating the better one as an extra, puts that risk on the supplier rather than on you.

Stage 3 — The board drives it, and your team runs it · $2,000

You get	You will see
Your Monday board connected both ways	Dragging a card to Shipped produces the packing list by itself
The connection locked so only Monday can trigger it	A forged instruction is rejected
Two training sessions, recorded	Someone from your office clears a flagged item unaided
The written guide and a one-page daily card for the wall	Delivered
Thirty days of free fixes after go-live	Starts the day you sign stage 3 off

Afterwards — support, if you want it · $350 a month

Alerting if it stops, security updates, backup restores actually tested, and two hours of changes a month. Month to month, thirty days' notice, and the system runs without it.

Two hours at the hourly rate is $190, so most of what the retainer buys is not activity — it is **somebody noticing before you do**, and being reachable without a ticket number.

> **Why that matters:** A system that quietly stopped working three days ago is far more expensive than the retainer, because nobody finds out until an order goes missing or a bill gets paid unchecked. The value is in the weeks when nothing happens.

Why this is worth more from me than from a support desk

I know who is in this business and what each person does with their day. When something looks wrong, you get somebody who already understands the question instead of somebody reading your account history back to you. **I am also not going anywhere.** A freelancer takes the next contract and a consultancy rotates whoever is free that week — in both cases the person who knows why the system does what it does stops being available, which is usually the moment a system like this quietly stops being used.

> **Why that matters:** Worth saying plainly: I have a direct interest in Allied running well, and if this works it is obvious whose it was — as it would be if it did not. That is a stronger commitment than a service level in a contract, and it is the one thing a firm found online cannot offer at any price.

Cost

	Basis	Amount
Stage 1 — Running on your machine	Fixed	$2,400
Stage 2 — Orders into Sage	Fixed	$1,600
Stage 3 — Board connected, team trained	Fixed	$2,000
Total	**Fixed**	**$6,000**
Optional — remove the Sage import click	Only if possible	$1,800
Optional — support	Monthly	$350
Further work beyond the monthly allowance	Hourly	$95

The total is about 63 hours at $95 an hour. For comparison, published 2026 rates put American IT consultants at $100 to $175 an hour and accounting-system specialists at $150 to $175.

> **Why that matters:** Pricing below the specialist rate is deliberate. A first job that completes and runs is worth more to both sides than a larger one that stalls getting approved — and you would rather the person who built it still be reachable in two years than have paid a firm that has moved on.

When you pay

Point	Share	Amount
On signing	40%	$2,400
When orders are reaching Sage	30%	$1,800
When your team is trained and it is yours	30%	$1,800

Time

Stage	Days	Waiting on you for
1 — Running on your machine	3–4	A computer, and your parts and customer lists
2 — Orders into Sage	2	Access to Sage to test an import
3 — Board connected, team trained	2–3	Monday access, and a couple of hours of staff time
Optional Sage extra	+2–3	Only if the one-minute check says it is possible
Total to working	**7–9**	**Excluding the optional extra**

What we need from you

- A Windows computer that stays on, able to reach Sage. An existing office PC is fine.
- Access to Sage to run a test import, and confirmation of which Sage you have.
- Administrator access to your Monday board.
- Your current parts, customer and supplier lists as spreadsheets.
- **One named person who will look at the review list every day once it is live.**
- A couple of hours of staff time for training.

> **Why that matters:** The person on the review list is the only item on that list that cannot be substituted with money. A system that flags problems nobody reads is worse than no system, because it creates the belief that someone is handling them.

What is not yet true

Stated plainly so nothing here reads as a claim the system cannot support. Each is handled by a stage above.

	Today	Fixed in
Sage	Produces the import files correctly. Does not write into your books by itself.	Stage 2, and the optional extra if possible
Monday board	Records what it would post. Does not post.	Stage 3
Your data	Running on 24 sample parts and a handful of customers.	Stage 1
Order email	Orders go in through the screen, not read from a mailbox.	Not included — priced separately later
Live use	Thoroughly tested. No real order has gone through it.	Stage 3 and the thirty days after
Backups	The routine is written and tested, but not yet running on your machine.	Stage 1

Why this is low risk for you

- **The thing already works.** You can watch it run before you sign anything.
- **You sign off each stage.** The money follows the milestones, not the calendar.
- **Nothing is irreversible.** Your current way of working keeps running throughout. The system adds entries to Sage; it does not replace Sage and does not touch anything already posted.
- **The rules are written down, not remembered.** 150 automatic checks mean the business rules are not held in one person's head.
- **You own it.** It runs on your computer, your data stays on your premises, and nothing is sent to any outside service.

> **Why that matters:** That last point is the one that is hard to get back once given away. Plenty of systems would do this work by shipping your customer list, your pricing and your supplier terms to somebody else's servers. The moment that happens, your commercial position is a line item in another company's database, and the terms under which it stays there are theirs to change.

Acceptance

Signing below means agreement to what is described here.

For Allied Welding Systems	For the supplier

Signed: _____	Signed: _____
Name: _____	Name: Alessio Naji
Title: _____	Title: _____
Date: _____	Date: _____

Valid until 24 December 2026. Third-party software prices were read from the vendors' own published pages on 24 October 2026 and can be changed by them at any time.